

through speech-to-text, image recognition, and smart assistants. These examples highlight just a fraction of the benefits already in use.

If there are benefits to AI, there are also several problems associated with it. For instance, if the data is biased, the AI will also be biased; due to lack of transparency it is hard to understand how the AI arrives at a conclusion; there can be misuse of personal data collected for AI; AI may be used for phishing scams or cyberattacks; automation through AI may make many jobs redundant; and overreliance on AI systems can prove dangerous in life-threatening situations in the fields of healthcare and law-enforcement, for instance.

Also, we should consider whether AI is making us lazy and dumb. The same question arose with the invention of a calculator, or even a bicycle! Eventually, we discovered that these new tools and inventions made us more efficient and productive, as we could accomplish much more in significantly less time. These, and many other tools and devices, have become an integral part of our lives, and now we can't do without them. Nobody wants to walk from Mumbai to Delhi, for instance, when the same distance can be covered through train or an airplane conveniently in a much shorter time.

So, in conclusion, we can say that AI can be used in both positive and negative ways, which is true for most other tools as well. Therefore, it is essential to establish guidelines and regulations for the responsible use of AI. Realising this, governments all over the world are working on it. Their main concerns at present are data privacy, safety, transparency, accountability, bias mitigation, and oversight.

Last year, the European Union introduced the first-ever comprehensive AI law, the EU AI Act (2024), which categorises AI systems based on their risks: unacceptable risk, high risk, and limited/minimal risk. It focuses

on transparency, human oversight, accuracy, and cybersecurity.

So far, there appears to be no single federal AI law in the USA. However, there is the AI Bill of Rights (2022), a non-binding framework that outlines rights related to AI, including protection from bias and the right to explanation. There are also state- and agency-level rules, such as FTC and NIST standards. Additionally, an executive order on AI (October 2023) has been issued, which mandates safety, testing, watermarking, and responsible development.

In India, there is currently no AI-specific legislation. The government's AI policy, at present, is governed by the National Strategy for AI (NITI Aayog, 2018) that promotes responsible AI and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act (2023), which outlines how AI should handle personal data. Discussions are ongoing on the ethical use of AI and regulations for public safety and education, etc.

There are, however, some common

regulatory principles governing AI across most nations, which include transparency, accountability, privacy and data protection, safety and robustness, and fairness and non-discrimination. Users must be aware that they are interacting with AI. Developers and operators are responsible for the outcomes. There should be compliance with the applicable data protection laws. AI systems must be safe for use in high-risk industries, such as healthcare and aviation. There should be no discrimination in hiring, lending, healthcare, or any other area.

There is so much to learn in this world, in the universe, in the galaxy of which our solar system is a part, and the many other galaxies of which our galaxy is just a minuscule part. With AI and its further developments, maybe we have a better chance of understanding what's going on within and around us. The more we learn, the more we realise that we know very little! So, AI is a boon for us in that sense.

Time to move to AGI

Artificial general intelligence (AGI) aims to mimic human intelligence, enabling it to make decisions autonomously, just like a human being. But when AGI starts replacing humans, what will we all do?

Do we really need to do something? How about basking in the Sun on a beach or besides a swimming pool, with a drink of our choice in our hands? But where will the money for the drink come from? Yes, that needs to be worked out!

Oh, how about making AI work and earn for us?

AGI is the next big thing! Many companies the world over are working on it, but mainly in the USA at present. It is likely to take at least two to three years to



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